WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

NORWAY

Europe

Information current as of November 2026

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office@lordwaverley.com
www.lordwaverley.com

WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Oslo	Capital and largest economy; seat of government, Norges Bank and the headquarters of many Norwegian and international companies	Finance, technology, life sciences, professional services
Bergen and Øygarden (west coast)	Home to the Northern Lights CO2 terminal at Øygarden, whose second phase will lift storage capacity from 1.5 to more than 5 million tonnes a year by 2028	Carbon capture and storage, subsea engineering, maritime
Stavanger and Rogaland	Centre of Norway's offshore energy industry and supply chain, facing the North Sea fields	Oil and gas services, offshore wind, energy technology
Utsira Nord (offshore, south-west)	Norway's first floating offshore wind areas, awarded in December 2025 to Equinor and Vårgrønn and to a Deep Wind Offshore and EDF Renouvelables consortium, with up to NOK 35 billion of state support	Floating offshore wind, marine engineering
Coastal and northern Norway	Long coastline hosting aquaculture, ports and Arctic logistics, with a land border with Russia in the far north	Aquaculture, seafood, green maritime, Arctic logistics
Industrial towns with hydropower	Access to renewable hydropower supports energy-intensive industry and new green industries	Data centres, batteries, hydrogen, metals

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Invest in Norway, part of Innovation Norway, is the official investment promotion agency and provides free information, opportunity assessment, network introductions and support through the investment process
- A 22% corporate income tax; upstream petroleum companies pay an additional 71.8% special tax, giving a 78% marginal rate within a stable, cash-flow-based regime
- EEA membership through EFTA, giving access to the EU single market for goods, services, capital and people, together with Schengen membership; Norway is not an EU member
- The Norwegian krone, with an independent central bank and free capital movement
- The Security Act's investment control regime, under which acquisitions of 10% or more in businesses subject to the Act must be notified, with a standstill until clearance

- State-supported energy-transition projects such as the Longship CCS programme and the Utsira Nord floating offshore wind tender, with up to NOK 35 billion of support
- Priority sectors promoted by Invest in Norway, including aquaculture, batteries, CCUS, data centres, hydrogen, green maritime, offshore wind, life sciences and space

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Norway in November 2026 offers investors one of the world's strongest public balance sheets, a stable political system and a world-class energy and maritime industry. The Government Pension Fund Global is worth about $2.3 trillion, and the 2027 budget presented in October 2026 draws NOK 608.4 billion from it, equal to 2.7% of the fund's value and within the fiscal rule. Mainland GDP grew 2.6% year-on-year in the second quarter of 2026, and the government forecasts mainland growth of 1.1% in 2026 and 1.7% in 2027. Energy-transition investment is substantial: Northern Lights is expanding to more than 5 million tonnes a year of CO2 storage, and Norway has awarded its first floating offshore wind areas at Utsira Nord. Unemployment remains low by European standards at 5.0% in September 2026.

Norway's main near-term challenge is inflation, which has kept interest rates high. Consumer price inflation was 3.4% in September 2026, and Norges Bank raised its policy rate to 4.5% in September and held it on 5 November, saying the rate will likely need to stay elevated for a time. Over the longer term, Norway must manage the gradual transition away from oil and gas revenue. The mitigation is strong: the fiscal rule ties spending to the fund's returns, the government expects core inflation to ease to 2.8% in 2027, and the September 2025 election returned a Labour government under Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Støre, with Jens Stoltenberg as finance minister and the next election not due until 2029. Norway's energy expertise and state backing for CCS, offshore wind and green industry create opportunities for investors positioned for the transition.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
High interest rates and inflation	Inflation of 3.4% and a policy rate of 4.5% raise financing costs	Inflation is forecast to ease in 2027; fix financing where possible and model a gradual easing path
Investment screening under the Security Act	Acquisitions of 10% or more in businesses subject to the Act must be notified, with review periods of up to 60 working days and a standstill	Assess notification early, build review time into deal timetables and engage advisers familiar with the regime
Minority government	Labour governs alone with 53 of 169 seats and needs other parties' support for budgets and laws	The fixed four-year term to 2029 and broad consensus on the fiscal rule support continuity; monitor budget negotiations
Russia sanctions and the northern border	Norway aligns with EU sanctions on Russia, including the 21st package from 21 October 2026, and shares a land border with Russia in the far north	Take sanctions and export-control advice for any Russia-linked trade or shipping; NATO membership provides a secure base
Currency exposure	The krone can move with oil prices and global risk sentiment	Hedge krone exposure and match revenues and costs; Norway's fund and fiscal rule underpin stability
High cost base	Wages and living costs are among the highest in Europe	Focus on high-productivity, automated and knowledge-intensive activities and use Norway's skilled workforce
Long lead times for energy projects	Offshore wind and other large projects need impact assessments and licences before final investment	Engage early with the Ministry of Energy and plan for staged licensing and state-aid competitions

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Norway's risk profile is among the lowest in Europe: a stable, high-income democracy and NATO member with a sovereign wealth fund of about $2.3 trillion, a transparent fiscal rule and strong legal institutions. The main near-term issue is inflation of 3.4%, which has led Norges Bank to raise its policy rate to 4.5%, increasing financing

costs; the government expects inflation to ease in 2027. Labour governs as a minority, but the fixed parliamentary term to 2029 and cross-party support for the fiscal rule provide continuity. Investors should note that acquisitions in businesses covered by the Security Act must be notified from a 10% stake, and that Norway applies EU sanctions on Russia, most recently the 21st package from October 2026, so sanctions and export-control advice is essential for any Russia-related business. Outside these areas, Norway offers a predictable, rules-based environment with full access to the EU single market through the EEA.

MARKET ACCESS

Through the EEA Agreement and EFTA membership, Norway gives investors access to the EU single market for goods, services, capital and people, and it is a member of Schengen and the WTO. EFTA's free trade agreements extend preferential access to many markets beyond Europe. Energy and seafood are central to Norway's exports, and its long Atlantic and Arctic coastline and offshore expertise position it as a hub for North Sea energy, for carbon storage serving European industrial emitters through Northern Lights, and for green shipping. Norway aligns with EU sanctions on Russia, so trade with Russia is limited to what those rules permit.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the Prime Minister (Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Støre)	Leads the Labour minority government, which sets economic, energy and industrial policy	Primary reference point for Norway's strategic direction and major projects
Invest in Norway (Innovation Norway)	Official investment promotion agency, offering free support to foreign companies	Standard first point of contact for market entry and investment enquiries
Norges Bank (Governor Ida Wolden Bache)	Sets monetary policy independently, with the policy rate held at 4.5% on 5 November 2026	Relevant for macroeconomic outlook, financial markets and interest-rate planning
Ministry of Finance (Minister Jens Stoltenberg)	Leads the budget, tax policy and the fiscal rule governing withdrawals from the fund	Key counterpart on tax and public-finance matters
Ministry of Energy	Manages petroleum licensing, offshore wind tenders including Utsira Nord, and CCS policy	Essential counterpart for energy and transition projects
Ministry of Foreign Affairs	Implements Norway's sanctions regulations, including alignment with EU packages on Russia	Counterpart for sanctions and export-control questions
Northern Lights	CO2 transport and storage company at Øygarden, part of the state-backed Longship programme	Partner for industrial emitters and CCS supply-chain firms

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The American Chamber of Commerce in Norway, national employers' and industry federations and bilateral chambers of commerce are the main business networks, with regular dialogue between business and government. Innovation Norway, through Invest in Norway, introduces investors to relevant networks and supports them through the investment process at no charge. Industry clusters in energy, maritime and aquaculture provide access to supply chains, and suppliers to the Northern Lights expansion and the Utsira Nord projects offer partnership routes for international firms. Embassies of major European partners and the United States in Oslo maintain commercial sections that are a useful source of introductions.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Norway suits investors seeking a stable, high-income EEA market with world-class energy and maritime capabilities: energy and engineering firms in offshore wind, carbon capture and storage and oil and gas services; green-maritime, hydrogen and battery companies; aquaculture and seafood-technology investors; data-centre operators drawn by renewable hydropower; and life-sciences and space-technology companies. Investors targeting security-sensitive businesses should plan for Security Act screening, and any Russia-linked activity requires sanctions advice.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage Invest in Norway
Use Invest in Norway's free services to assess opportunities, identify locations and secure introductions to relevant networks.

STEP 2: Check Security Act notification requirements
Assess whether a target falls under the investment control regime and build notification and review periods into the timetable.

STEP 3: Position for energy-transition programmes
Track the Utsira Nord licensing process, Northern Lights expansion and other state-backed projects for supply and partnership opportunities.

STEP 4: Plan for rates, inflation and currency
Model the 4.5% policy rate and krone exposure, and follow Norges Bank's December 2026 decision and the 2027 budget negotiations.

STEP 5: Screen counterparts for sanctions exposure
Take sanctions and export-control advice for any counterparts, vessels or supply chains with links to Russia.